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Exporting India

For Haryana based ShalinCraft, the Internet was the gateway to getting Indian art—and other products—to a worldwide market

Preethi Chamikutty

There is currently a large worldwide market for Indian art. And the Internet is, naturally, facilitating this exchange. Indians settled abroad as well as those in India have started exporting Indian art overseas. As a case in point, we take a look at Shalini Verma, founder and director of Shalin-Craft India, who returned to India from France to set up her own business.

In The Beginning

Verma's company was first named Shalin Fine Arts. ('Shalin' means 'grace' in Hindi.) In 1996, Verma established ShalinCraft, because she was "not enjoying sitting idle at home." Shalin-Craft earlier sold Western art reprints in India, called European trend prints. These were imported from France. Architects and interior designers were the channels of distribution.

The clientele mostly comprised offices and hotels

that were interested in the art for their décor.

In 1998, when the rupee was devalued, the company faced problems in importing artwork. It was then that Verma decided to use the Internet as a medium of conducting business—and rather than importing, to get into exports. Verma chose to export hand crafted Indian products, since after having dealt in art products for over two years, she had developed "an eye for beautiful products."

Imaging Atul Deshmukh



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